

ENGLISH LANGUAGE PAPER 4

PART A Group Interaction

Below is an extract from a website about upcycling:

WHAT IS UPCYCLING?

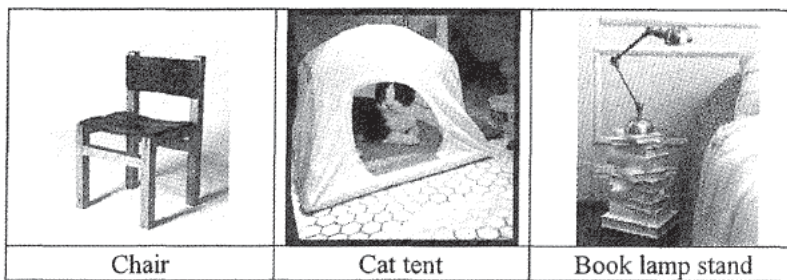
Upcycling is the process of converting waste materials or useless products into new materials or products of better quality or for better environmental value. When you upcycle an item, you aren't breaking down the materials. You may be refashioning it but it's still made of the same materials as when you started. Also, the upcycled item is typically better or the same quality as the original.

Upcycling is not a new concept. Some of the best examples of upcycling come from the 1930s and 40s when families had very little economic or material resources. During that time, people reused almost everything, repurposing items over and over until they were no longer useful: feed sacks became dresses or old doors became the new dining room table. What was old was new again, but with a twist.

One of the biggest reasons for the rebirth of upcycling is the positive impact on the environment. Items destined for the dump are rescued and remade into something useful. When you upcycle, you remove items from the global garbage stream. Upcycling instead of recycling is good too; recycling requires energy or water to break down materials. Upcycling only requires your own creativity and upcycled products can rival those found in high-end department stores.

Examples of items that can be upcycled are:

- old tyres → chair
- old t-shirts → cat tent
- old books → lamp stand



Your school has decided to organize an upcycling campaign. As part of the campaign your group is going to upcycle one item shown in the three photos above. You may want to talk about:

- which item to upcycle and why
- difficulties you may face
- how to sell your upcycled product
- anything else you think is important

PART B Individual Response

1. Do you recycle things that you buy?
2. What do you do with your old clothes?
3. What do you do with your unwanted books?
4. How convenient is it for you to upcycle?
5. How can we encourage people to upcycle more?
6. How successful is your school at upcycling?
7. Do you think shops should sell upcycled products?
8. Do you think Hong Kong does enough to upcycle waste?